Live interview questions

Ask one question at a time. Let them finish. Skip questions they have already answered naturally.

Before recording

Ask: **"Are you good with me recording this? We will go over what can be shared before anything gets posted."**

- ☐ Record a 20 second test and play it back. Check clear speech and reduce nearby noise.
- ☐ Put phones on Do Not Disturb. Confirm camera framing and available recording space.

Opening: "I want to hear how you got into hunting, then we will get into that hunt. Just tell it how you remember it."

The hunter

1. How did you get started hunting?

2. Who took you the first time? What do you remember about that?

3. What keeps you going back?

The buildup

4. What hunt are we talking about today? Why does that one stand out?

5. Before that hunt, what did you know about that deer? Had you been watching it, or was this your first encounter?

6. What had you put into getting ready? Walk me through the scouting and your setup.

7. Take me back to that day. What was happening before you headed out?

8. Where were you sitting, and what were the conditions like?

9. What happened while you were waiting?

Follow an answer

"What happened next?" "Can you describe that?"
"When you say that, what do you mean?"
"You mentioned something earlier. Can we go back to that?"

While they talk: Leave a pause after each answer. Nod instead of talking over them. Their uninterrupted voice will carry the hunting scenes.

The encounter and the ending

Get the sequence clearly. Let the hunter supply the emotion and meaning. Keep uncertain details uncertain.

Slow down at the encounter

10. What was the first thing that made you realize the deer was there?

11. What was it doing? Walk me through what you were seeing.

12. What was going through your head right then?

13. What made you decide to act, wait, or let it go?

14. Take me through what happened next, as closely as you remember it.

15. What did you actually see or hear afterward?

16. What did you do next? Walk me through how the hunt ended.

Follow the outcome

Recovered: "Tell me about finding it. Who was there, and who did you tell first?"

Missed or passed: "What happened to the deer afterward? Did you ever get another chance?"

Not recovered: "Walk me through the search. What could you confirm, and what never got answered?"

What stayed with them

17. When you think about that hunt now, what moment comes back first?

18. What made it matter to you beyond whether you got the deer?

19. Did it change how you hunted afterward?

20. What happened after that season? Is there more to this story?

21. What have I not asked that you want people to understand?

Before they leave

Complete the details and sharing preferences sheets. Ask what photos or footage exist, what must stay private, and how to reach them for the edit review.

Hunter and story details

Record only the public location detail they are comfortable sharing. Keep contact information private.

Interview date and time

Hunter name and preferred public name

Name pronunciation and optional credit or social handle

Phone or email for follow up and review

Hunt year or season and general area

People involved and how they should be credited

Brief story summary

Confirmed outcome and details still uncertain

Photos footage messages or keepsakes available and who owns them

Location access or other details to film later

Details names and locations to keep private

Story notes and follow up

Hunter _____ Interview date _____

Preparation and the day of the hunt

The encounter and the outcome

Strong quotes and recording times

Write their actual words when possible. Note a recording time so you can find the moment again.

Missing facts footage and next step

Recording and sharing preferences

Choose one answer for each item. Recording permission is separate from publication permission. Anything marked Discuss later remains unapproved.

Hunter: _____ Date: _____

Preferred public name: _____

We will arrange your review of factual details and portrayal before publication. Additional uses or changes to these selections will be discussed with you.

Use or permission	Yes	No	Discuss later
Record this interview	☐	☐	☐
Include my account in the edited documentary	☐	☐	☐
Publish the feature on the website and video channel	☐	☐	☐
Use approved interview excerpts in social posts	☐	☐	☐
Use approved still images from this interview	☐	☐	☐
Create a member page with my approved name and story	☐	☐	☐
Introduce me as a member of The Whitetail Syndicate	☐	☐	☐
Use supplied photos or footage after ownership and permissions are confirmed	☐	☐	☐
Discuss separate paid advertising use	☐	☐	☐

Member recognition identifies the hunter featured in the story. Any apparel endorsement, payment, or other arrangement will be discussed separately.

Privacy limits or conditions on any selected use

Review contact and next step: _____

These selections record my current preferences. Please contact me about changes or additional uses.

Participant signature: _____ Date: _____

Interviewer: _____ Date: _____